

KUTUMBA

C1-W3 — Main Facilitator

Speaking map and session leadership

C1-W3 • The Nature of the Soul

V13 • Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness
Program Director: Swapnil Patil

Internal founding-cohort teaching material — human/temple review EXTERNAL_OPEN

KUTUMBA | Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness

Locked Saturday Schedule

Time	Block
1:50–2:00	Arrival
2:00–2:10	Opening mantras + welcome
2:10–2:30	All-family launch/orientation
2:30–3:10	Parallel tracks
3:10–3:30	Reunification + bhakti laboratory
3:30–3:40	Snack + water
3:40–3:55	Saṅkalpa + project + home practice
3:55–4:00	Close

TIME CUE	Track handoff is at 2:30; all groups reunite at 3:10.
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Primary verse: BG 2.20
Source URL: <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/>

Main Facilitator Guide

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Week: C1-W3 — The Nature of the Soul • **Date:** 2026-09-26 **Entry point:** [V13-WEEK-START-HERE.md](#)

KUTUMBA • Families Growing in Krishna Consciousness Program Director: Swapnil Patil **Status:**

Internal founding-cohort teaching material — human/temple review EXTERNAL_OPEN **Controlling guide:**

This V13 file is authoritative for Saturday delivery. Core teaching is inlined below.

Two-minute summary

The jīva is eternal, conscious, individual, minute, and related to Kṛṣṇa in service — not God Himself.

Primary: **BG 2.20** (<https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/>). Essential question: If I am a soul, how should I live?

Essential question

If I am a soul, how should I live?

15-minute night-before prep

1. Open <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/> and reread Devanāgarī, IAST, and KUTUMBA teaching meaning below.
2. Rehearse the **speaking script** section aloud once (aim for clear 10–15 minute delivery with pauses).
3. Pack younger + older + parent printables from [activities/v13-*](#).
4. Review misconception to block: **All souls are God / we are the Supreme.**
5. Confirm snack/water only (no weekly meal); parents onsite; privacy reminder card visible.
6. For C1-W4: verify Mṛgārī source cards say **CC Madhya 24.229–282** (not SB 6.x / SB 4.8).

60-minute deep prep

1. Read the inlined analogies, examples, and three cases in this guide until you can teach them without notes.
2. Mark which discovery / understanding / application questions you will actually ask.
3. Choose one analogy and one case as your "must teach" pair; keep the others ready for Q&A.
4. Walk the room: parent circle, younger zone, older zone, reunification seats.
5. Pre-write the home-practice minimum version on a card (5 minutes counts).
6. Review deferral line: laboratory methods measure bodies/behavior; ātman/bhakti claims rest on śāstra — no false science proof.
7. Skim [project/V13-MODULE-PROJECT-BRIEF.md](#) for this week's artifact layer.
8. Optional enrichment only (not a substitute for this guide): [research/V13-*](#) files.

Exact primary and supporting readings

Primary (locked)

- **Reference:** BG 2.20
- **URL:** <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/>
- **Devanāgarī:** न जायते म्रियते वा कदाचिन्नायं भूत्वा भविता वा न भूयः । अजो नित्यः शाश्वतोऽयं पुराणो न हन्यते हन्यमाने शरीरे ॥ २० ॥
- **IAST:** na jāyate mriyate vā kadācin nāyaṁ bhūtvā bhavitā vā na bhūyaḥ / ajo nityaḥ śāśvato 'yaṁ purāṇo na hanyate hanyamāne śarīre
- **KUTUMBA teaching meaning:** The soul is never born and never dies; unborn, eternal, and everlasting — not destroyed when the body is destroyed.
- **Rights:** Sanskrit verse text from VedaBase display; KUTUMBA teaching meaning original; no full purport.

Supporting readings

- BG 15.7 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/> — Living entities are eternal fragmental parts of Kṛṣṇa — qualitative likeness, quantitative difference.
- BG 2.17 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/17/> — That which pervades the body is indestructible.
- ŚB 5.10 (Jaḍa Bharata context) — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/5/10/> — Narrative support: soul beyond bodily status labels — gentle paraphrase only.

Teaching map with exact Saturday 1:50–4:00 time cues

Time	Block	Facilitator focus
1:50–2:00	Arrival	Welcome; privacy; parents onsite; materials check
2:00–2:10	Opening mantras	Keep simple; invitation not volume contest
2:10–2:30	Shared opening / Prem-kī-Kathā + verse	Deliver opening of speaking script; state memory line
2:30–3:10	Parallel tracks	Parent circle / younger / older — see track transition
3:10–3:30	Reunification / bhakti lab	Family synthesis sentence; no ranking
3:30–3:40	Snack + water only	No weekly meal service
3:40–3:55	Saṅkalpa / project / Q&A	Home cue + project artifact + likely questions

Time	Block	Facilitator focus
3:55–4:00	Closing	Next-week title only; no early ontology

10–20 minute speaking script (deliverable prose)

Facilitation note: Speak naturally. Pause for the 20-second pair share where indicated. Do not replace this with "see research."

Tonight we go one step deeper than last week. Week 2 said the body changes and the self continues. Week 3 asks what kind of self that is.

Essential question: If I am a soul, how should I live?

Primary: BG 2.20 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/>

Teaching meaning: "The soul is never born and never dies; unborn, eternal, and everlasting — not destroyed when the body is destroyed."

Conclusion: The jīva is eternal, conscious, individual, minute, and related to Kṛṣṇa in service — not God Himself.

Please hear the is/is-not map clearly. The jīva is eternal, conscious, and individual. The jīva is a minute fragmental part related to Kṛṣṇa in service (BG 15.7). The jīva is **not** the temporary body. The jīva is **not** the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

If a child says "I am God," we smile and correct: "You are a dear spark meant to serve, not the whole sun."

Sun-and-ray, spark-from-fire, house-and-resident — all are pedagogy with limits. Rays are not the sun. Residents still care for the house.

Narrative support: Jaḍa Bharata's teaching context in ŚB 5.10 reminds us bodily status labels do not define the soul (<https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/5/10/>). Keep retellings gentle and nonviolent.

Science boundary for this week is explicit: **N/A — no empirical claim is used to prove or disprove ātman.** Laboratory methods measure bodies and behavior. If asked for science proof of the soul, say so out loud and defer doctrine to śāstra.

Case: neglecting hygiene "because we are soul." That is body contempt, not spirituality. Restore care as service readiness.

Supporting readings:

- BG 15.7 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/> — Living entities are eternal fragmental parts of Kṛṣṇa — qualitative likeness, quantitative difference.
- BG 2.17 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/17/> — That which pervades the body is indestructible.
- ŚB 5.10 (Jaḍa Bharata context) — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/5/10/> — Narrative support: soul beyond bodily status labels — gentle paraphrase only.

Memory: I am an eternal soul — conscious, individual, and meant for Kṛṣṇa's service.

I am going to teach the analogies slowly, with limits in the same breath, because an analogy without a limit becomes a new false doctrine.

First: **Sun and sunray**. Ray shares light-nature with the sun but is not the sun. Limit: Ray is not the sun — blocks 'I am God.'

Second: **Spark from fire**. Same nature, dependent existence. Limit: Not independent Godhood; dependence remains.

Third: **House and resident**. Resident is not the house; still cares for the house. Limit: Can feel impersonal if overused — keep personhood of the jīva clear.

Hold those as teaching tools, not as replacements for BG 2.20.

Now two sourced examples, paraphrased only.

Example A — Jaḍa Bharata and King Rahūgaṇa (ŚB 5.9–5.10). Bodily labels (carrier, king, appearance) do not define the soul. Classroom retelling must be nonviolent and symbolic; no invented dialogue. Link: <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/5/10/>

Example B — Fragmental part teaching (BG 15.7). Supports individuality + relationship to Kṛṣṇa without claiming Supreme identity. Link: <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/>

Next I will walk all three household cases out loud so you can copy the pattern at home. Please listen for seven fields every time: situation, mistaken conclusion, principle, source, compassionate response, action, and what not to say.

Case 1. Situation: A child proudly says, 'I am God.' Mistaken conclusion: Soul equals the Supreme. Principle and source: BG 15.7 — eternal fragmental part; BG 2.20 — eternal individual self. (<https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/>) Compassionate response: Smile; correct gently: we are tiny parts meant to serve, not the whole. Family action: Practice the sentence: 'I am a soul who serves Kṛṣṇa.' What not to say: You're blasphemous. Shame the child publicly.

Case 2. Situation: An adult dismisses soul talk as anti-science. Mistaken conclusion: Science has disproved the soul. Principle and source: Different domains: empiricism measures bodies/behavior; śāstra teaches ātman. (Program science boundary + BG 2.20) Compassionate response: Agree that labs measure physical processes. Clarify we are not claiming a lab proof of ātman tonight. Family action: Offer the deferral line; invite reading the verse URL later. What not to say: Scientists are demons. Faith means never asking questions.

Case 3. Situation: A family neglects sleep and hygiene 'because we are soul.' Mistaken conclusion: Body contempt is spiritual. Principle and source: Care without identity confusion — resident cares for house. (Pedagogy limit of house analogy + prior W2 care theme) Compassionate response: Restore basic care as service readiness, not as identity. Family action: Pick one body-care act (sleep time / water / bathing) as service this week. What not to say: The body is illusion so ignore doctors. Only weak people rest.

I will now ask the room three discovery questions. You may answer in a whisper to a partner:

- What does 'eternal' mean in kid words?
- Where do people confuse 'soul' with 'I am God'?
- What is one way a soul shows service at home?

Understanding check — please be ready to say in one sentence: The jīva is eternal, conscious, individual, minute, and related to Kṛṣṇa in service — not God Himself.. Name the primary: BG 2.20. Name what we are

not teaching tonight: ranking, speculation, and the misconception “All souls are God / we are the Supreme.”.

Application — before you leave the shared opening, decide silently: time + place for home practice; who starts if others are tired; and the minimum version if the week is hard. Five minutes counts. Memory line plus one kind action counts.

Let me demonstrate a minimum home practice out loud so nobody leaves confused. Tonight after dinner, or at the same chair each evening, someone says the memory line once: “I am an eternal soul — conscious, individual, and meant for Kṛṣṇa's service..” Then one family member paraphrases BG 2.20 in a single sentence. Then one gratitude or service act — thanking someone, offering water, putting shoes away as kindness, or a short prayer. If the house is chaotic, keep only the memory line and one kind action. That still honors tonight's conclusion: The jīva is eternal, conscious, individual, minute, and related to Kṛṣṇa in service — not God Himself.

When we reunite at 3:10, I will not score families. I will ask for one sentence: “This week we will...” Drawings count. Whispered parent sentences count. Loud brilliance is not holier than quiet sincerity.

Likely questions you may hear from adults — rehearse these answers with me:

If someone asks, “Are we God?” — answer: No. We are eternal fragmental parts meant for service (BG 15.7).

If someone asks, “Can science prove the soul?” — answer: N/A as proof. Empiricism does not establish ātman; we teach from śāstra.

If someone asks, “Is the soul created at birth?” — answer: BG 2.20 teaches the soul is never born and never dies — paraphrase carefully; avoid speculative cosmology debates.

If someone asks, “Do animals have souls?” — answer: Gauḍīya teaching affirms life in many forms; keep class focused on human family practice tonight without species contempt.

If someone asks, “What should I *do* if I am a soul?” — answer: Live as a servant of Kṛṣṇa: hear, remember, serve, speak respectfully — start with this week's home cue.

A short word on boundaries. We do not invent quotations. We do not dump full purports into Git or into the room. We do not diagnose families medically or spiritually in public. We do not guarantee initiation, advancement, or certification. We do not claim human, temple, CPO, or publication approval. Science may help habits; it does not prove ātman or replace śāstra.

Operational covenant aloud: Saturday 1:50–4:00 (teaching window 2:00–4:00); snack and water only; parents onsite; private struggles stay private; no false approval labels.

Recite with me before tracks:

- Essential question: If I am a soul, how should I live?
- Conclusion: The jīva is eternal, conscious, individual, minute, and related to Kṛṣṇa in service — not God Himself.
- Memory line: I am an eternal soul — conscious, individual, and meant for Kṛṣṇa's service.
- Misconception to block: All souls are God / we are the Supreme.
- Primary: BG 2.20 — <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/2/20/>

Parents: your job in the parent circle is not to perform brilliance. It is to leave with a cue, a minimum version, and a kinder sentence than the one you might have used last week. Younger and older teachers will deepen practice in age bands. We reunite at 3:10 for one family sentence: “This week we will...”

That is the heart of tonight's teaching. Let us practice it, not merely admire it.

Analogies with limits (inline — teach from here)

1. Sun and sunray

- **Teaches:** Ray shares light-nature with the sun but is not the sun.
- **Limit (say out loud):** Ray is not the sun — blocks 'I am God.'

2. Spark from fire

- **Teaches:** Same nature, dependent existence.
- **Limit (say out loud):** Not independent Godhood; dependence remains.

3. House and resident

- **Teaches:** Resident is not the house; still cares for the house.
- **Limit (say out loud):** Can feel impersonal if overused — keep personhood of the jīva clear.

Scriptural and devotional examples (inline paraphrase)

1. Jaḍa Bharata and King Rahūgaṇa

- **Provenance:** ŚB 5.9–5.10
- **URL:** <https://vedabase.io/en/library/sb/5/10/>
- **Classroom paraphrase use:** Bodily labels (carrier, king, appearance) do not define the soul. Classroom retelling must be nonviolent and symbolic; no invented dialogue.

2. Fragmental part teaching

- **Provenance:** BG 15.7
- **URL:** <https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/>
- **Classroom paraphrase use:** Supports individuality + relationship to Kṛṣṇa without claiming Supreme identity.

Three constructed household cases (inline)

Constructed case 1

Field	Content
Situation	A child proudly says, 'I am God.'
Mistaken conclusion	Soul equals the Supreme.
Principle	BG 15.7 — eternal fragmental part; BG 2.20 — eternal individual self.
Source	https://vedabase.io/en/library/bg/15/7/
Compassionate response	Smile; correct gently: we are tiny parts meant to serve, not the whole.

Field	Content
Family action	Practice the sentence: 'I am a soul who serves Kṛṣṇa.'
What not to say	You're blasphemous. Shame the child publicly.

Constructed case 2

Field	Content
Situation	An adult dismisses soul talk as anti-science.
Mistaken conclusion	Science has disproved the soul.
Principle	Different domains: empiricism measures bodies/behavior; śāstra teaches ātman.
Source	Program science boundary + BG 2.20
Compassionate response	Agree that labs measure physical processes. Clarify we are not claiming a lab proof of ātman tonight.
Family action	Offer the deferral line; invite reading the verse URL later.
What not to say	Scientists are demons. Faith means never asking questions.

Constructed case 3

Field	Content
Situation	A family neglects sleep and hygiene 'because we are soul.'
Mistaken conclusion	Body contempt is spiritual.
Principle	Care without identity confusion — resident cares for house.

Field	Content
Source	Pedagogy limit of house analogy + prior W2 care theme
Compassionate response	Restore basic care as service readiness, not as identity.
Family action	Pick one body-care act (sleep time / water / bathing) as service this week.
What not to say	The body is illusion so ignore doctors. Only weak people rest.

Discovery questions

1. What does 'eternal' mean in kid words?
2. Where do people confuse 'soul' with 'I am God'?
3. What is one way a soul shows service at home?

Understanding questions

1. List three truths about the jīva from today's teaching.
2. Name what the jīva is *not*.
3. Cite BG 2.20's teaching meaning in your own words.

Application questions

1. What offering or service act will we do this week?
2. How will we correct 'I am God' language at home?
3. What body-care act will we keep as service?

Five likely Q&A

Question	Source-based direction
Are we God?	No. We are eternal fragmental parts meant for service (BG 15.7).
Can science prove the soul?	N/A as proof. Empiricism does not establish ātman; we teach from śāstra.

Question	Source-based direction
Is the soul created at birth?	BG 2.20 teaches the soul is never born and never dies — paraphrase carefully; avoid speculative cosmology debates.
Do animals have souls?	Gauḍīya teaching affirms life in many forms; keep class focused on human family practice tonight without species contempt.
What should I *do* if I am a soul?	Live as a servant of Kṛṣṇa: hear, remember, serve, speak respectfully — start with this week's home cue.

Misconceptions to block

- All souls are God / we are the Supreme.
- Confusing analogy with scripture quotation
- Importing next week's full ontology early
- Ranking families or children
- Claiming science proves or disproves ātman / bhakti metaphysics
- False human, temple, CPO, or publication approval labels

What not to speculate about

- Invented quotations, purport dumps, or unverified lecture lines
- Private medical or spiritual diagnoses of families
- Guarantees of advancement, initiation, or certification
- Graphic retellings (especially Mṛgāri) or fear-based death pressure on children
- For W4: any claim that Mṛgāri is located in SB 6.x or SB 4.8

Track transition (say at ~2:28)

Parents remain in the parent circle. Younger friends go with [younger teacher]. Older students go with [older teacher]. We reunite at 3:10. We do not rank groups.

Family reunification synthesis (3:10–3:30)

Invite one sentence per family tied to the essential question:

"This week we will..."

Accept drawings or whispered parent sentences for shy children. No scoreboard.

Project contribution

Advance the cumulative project **Who Am I, and How Should Our Family Live?** using `project/V13-MODULE-PROJECT-BRIEF.md`. This week layer must connect to BG 2.20 and tonight's conclusion. Store artifacts for Week 6. Non-competitive.

Home practice (5–15 minutes)

1. Say the memory line once: *I am an eternal soul — conscious, individual, and meant for Kṛṣṇa's service.*
2. Paraphrase BG 2.20 in one family sentence.
3. Do one gratitude or service act.
4. Minimum version if exhausted: memory line + one kind action only.

Next-week preview

Name only: **C1-W4 — Why Human Life Is Rare and Valuable**. Do not teach next week's ontology in depth tonight.

Do not claim

Human/temple/CPO approval; publication readiness; BBT ownership of KUTUMBA teaching meanings; science proving ātman; ranking results; guaranteed spiritual outcomes.

Misconceptions and no-speculation boundaries

- Do not invent dialogue for scriptural persons.
- Do not diagnose private karma or modes as insults in the room.
- Do not claim temple/BBT/human approval that has not been given.
- Defer off-scope questions with the standard deferral line.

RIGHTS NOTE

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